

EM ASIA FX/RATES VIEWS

Asian central banks stepping up response to stem FX weakness

1. Asian central banks step up with hikes and FX policy measures to contain inflation and FX weakness. Asian FX has weakened materially since the start of the Middle East conflict, with all regional currencies except the CNY depreciating against the USD, and USD/KRW, USD/IDR, USD/PHP and USD/INR have all broken prior highs. Given policymakers' and the market's early assumption that the shock would be short-lived, the policymakers' first-order response was to intervene, which is reflected in the broad drawdown in FX reserves. However, as the conflict has entered its fourth month, policy responses have since broadened across Asia. The BSP raised the policy rate by 25bp to 4.50% in April, citing concerns over inflation. BI reiterated its triple intervention policy in March, raised the term structure of interest rates in April, and ultimately hiked by 50bp in May and 25bp in an off-cycle meeting in June. BI also announced a slew of measures aimed at bolstering inflows. The RBI has so far kept policy rates unchanged, but also announced measures to attract inflows in line with our economists' expectations prior to the June meeting. In Korea, where KRW weakness appears more closely tied to portfolio flows, the authorities have leaned more heavily on capital-flow management measures (i.e., encouraging National Pension Service hedging), even as the BoK kept rates on hold while shifting to a more hawkish tone. We think these measures have been somewhat effective, as they put a brake on the slide in Asian FX.

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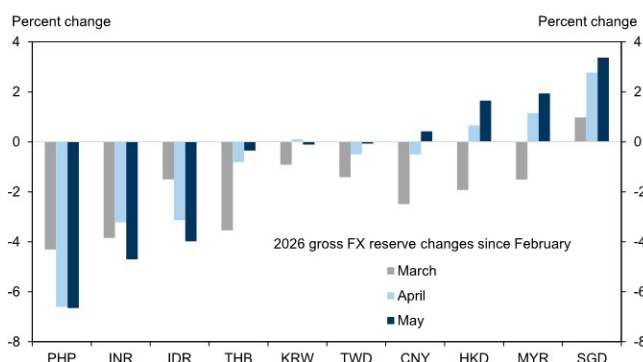
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Exhibit 1: FX reserves have dropped in most Asian economies since February



Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

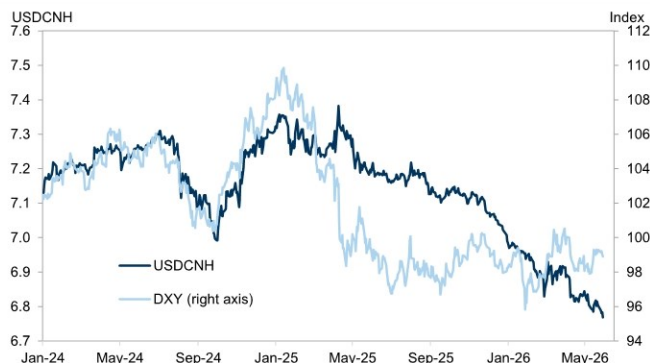
2. Policy action helps to stabilize Asian FX, but significant appreciation vs. USD unlikely without resolution of energy shock. Unless there is a clear resolution to the Middle East conflict and oil prices drop significantly, we note that the current

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market narrative on the broad USD is a supportive one. The energy shock is less adverse to the US economy compared to Europe and Asia. The AI-related investment boom has fueled the US equity market rally. Market Fed rate expectations have turned more hawkish, and our US team has pushed back their Fed cut expectations to 2027, while lifting their US 10Y yield forecasts to 4.4% (from 4.1%). These macro variables should keep USD/Asia broadly supported, at least until there is more sustained positive news on the war, which could reverse the terms-of-trade outlook for Asia if oil prices drop. In terms of relative performance within EM Asia, we think the RBI's FX measures were meaningful, and given their war chest of reserves, we expect the INR to outperform other high-yield Asian currencies. BI's measures have helped to stabilize the IDR's slide, but a rising domestic risk premium (see below) should curb IDR gains. The PHP should also stay on the defensive (given its reliance on energy imports), but could be one of the region's outperformers if there is a resolution to the war. Among the low-yield currencies, the CNY is on a clear appreciation path, while tech-related currencies (TWD, MYR and KRW) should outperform, while THB underperforms.

3. China - Policy anchor behind the stronger CNY and lower rates. April's activity data came in weaker than expected, which has raised questions whether the PBoC would shift to a more accommodative stance, but our economists think the threshold for broad easing is high. Growth remains bifurcated with exports still supporting headline growth while domestic demand remains soft. Oil-led deflation complicates the case for broad monetary easing. Instead, we think policy support is going to come via fiscal or low-profile easing (such as maintaining ample liquidity). The CNY appreciation trend has persisted throughout the Middle East conflict, despite the broad USD strengthening versus all other Asian currencies. In our view, the PBoC appears comfortable with orderly gradual CNY appreciation against the USD, with a pace of around 4% annualized likely fast enough to offset carry costs for foreign investors, but slow enough to keep the drag on exports competitive and inflation limited. Gradual currency appreciation is also in sync with policymakers pursuit of RMB internationalization, in our view. We acknowledge that the appreciation expectations have become more one-sided, raising exporter's FX conversion ratios. We estimate that exporters converted USD 150bn more FX proceeds than normal since last December (versus our earlier estimate that excess corporate USD hoarding reached a peak of around USD 500bn mid-2025). Going forward, the combination of ongoing export outperformance, significant CNY undervaluation and PBoC's policy preference, we think the CNY will continue on its gradual appreciation path towards 6.70 in 6M and 6.50 in 12M.

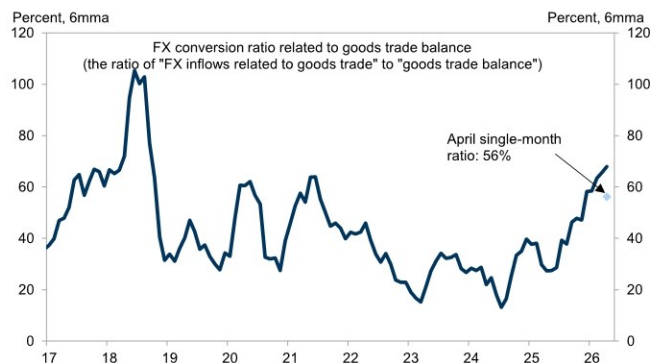
Exhibit 2: CNH continued to strengthen vs. USD despite rangebound DXY



DXY: US Dollar Index, which measures the value of the US Dollar vs. a basket of currencies.

Source: Bloomberg

Exhibit 3: FX conversion ratio for goods trade balance has generally been rising



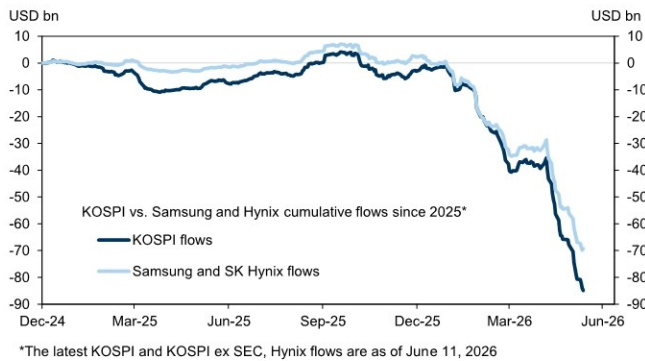
The line shows a six-month moving average of FX conversion ratio.

Source: CEIC, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

4. South Korea - AI-driven current account surplus being offset by equity outflows.

The AI-driven export boom has been very supportive for Korean exports, fiscal revenues and growth this year. The BoK kept policy rates unchanged in May, but turned more hawkish. The median dot plot is now projecting two 25 hikes over the next six months, versus none in February. The BoK raised its 2026 real GDP forecast by 0.6pp to 2.6% (vs. GS and Bloomberg consensus: 2.5%), while raising their headline inflation forecast by 0.5pp to 2.7%. Our economists expect two 25bps hikes (most likely in July and October) versus the market's pricing of six hikes over the next 12-months. We are more dovish because the driver of growth is very concentrated in semi-conductors and not broad-based, which matters for the magnitude of tightening, in our view. Despite the surge in exports and 90% rally in the KOSPI year-to-date, the KRW has counter-intuitively underperformed Asian FX. Last year, heavy portfolio outflows by the National Pension Service (NPS) and retail investors buying overseas assets led to KRW weakness. This year, foreign investors have net sold USD 80bn of Korean equities year-to-date. Our equity strategists note that the recent KOSPI rally has been led by two large semiconductor companies, which pushed their index weight above diversification thresholds, resulting in foreign equity selling, despite higher stocks prices. Our equity strategists believe that equity outflows could ease if the KOSPI rally broadens out beyond just two companies, which would reduce the selling related to concentration risk, while attracting inflows into the broader market. Fundamentally, we are constructive on the KRW via the current account channel, but believe equity outflows would need to abate before the KRW can outperform NJA peers.

Exhibit 4: Net foreign outflows from the KOSPI have reached approximately US\$80bn, largely driven by the two largest semiconductor stocks.



Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: The rally in two semiconductor stocks pushed their index weights above diversification thresholds under the Investment Company Act of 1940



Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

5. Taiwan - Stellar exports drive growth and TWD's relative outperformance.

Taiwan's exports have been growing at a pace of around 40–70% yoy for most of this year. Most recently, May exports rose 51.7% yoy (vs. consensus of 41.2%). Q1 GDP growth rose to 13.7% yoy (well above consensus of 11.3%), reaching the strongest figure since Q2 1987. Our economists have revised up their 2026 current account forecast to 25% of GDP, versus what was a record 20% in 2025, and revised up their 2026 GDP forecast to 10.3% (from 7.0% previously), which would be amongst the highest growth rate since the 1980s. Given the strong growth and rising inflation (GSe: 2.0% by Q2-2026) from 1.2% in Q1, our economists expect the CBC to hike rates twice by 12.5bp in June (out of consensus call) and in Q4, to reach a terminal rate of 2.25% (from 2.0% currently). The TWD has outperformed Asian FX since the start of the Middle East conflict. Taiwan's semi-conductor exports have helped to offset the impact of higher oil prices on their terms of trade. Unlike South Korea (which has seen foreign equity outflows all year), foreign equity flows have been more mixed in Taiwan (–USD 14bn year-to-date, but +USD 5bn quarter-to-date). With portfolio flows mixed, the very strong current account surplus is helping to bolster the TWD's performance in a bullish USD environment. Going forward, we expect the TWD to continue outperforming Asian FX, although the pace should be gradual, reflecting the CBC's preference for relative stability.

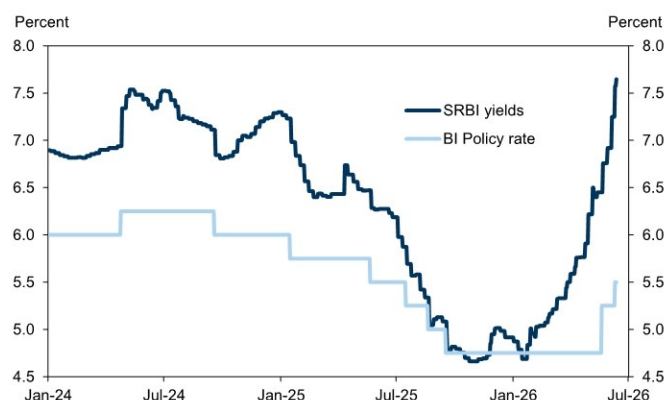
6. India - FX regulations help to stabilize the INR; we recommend going short THB/INR.

Despite the sharp rise in oil prices, India's growth has surprised to the upside. Q1 GDP growth rose 7.8% yoy (versus 8.0% in Q4-25), which was attributed to strong investment. The RBI kept policy rates unchanged in June and retained a "neutral" stance. We expect two 25bps hikes in 2026 (likely in October and December). If inflation accelerates faster than we expect, the risk is that the RBI brings forward the rate hike to August. The RBI also announced a slew of FX measures to encourage capital inflows. These include exemption of tax on capital gains or interest income for foreign investments in government securities, foreign investor access extended to securities further out to ultra-long-end maturities, and exemptions for banks raising foreign currency bonds and deposits. We think the FX measures are meaningful enough to stabilize the USD/INR and like it as a carry play. Carry levels in the INR have increased since the beginning of the US-Iran War, and they are now higher than other Asia high-yielders (IDR and PHP). While the Rupee is still at fair levels on a trade-weighted

basis and rich relative to key currencies like CNY, it now screens among the more undervalued EM currencies versus the Dollar among the higher carry complex on our GSDEER and GSFEER metrics. As such, **we recommend going short THB/INR** (entry 2.91, target 2.70, stop-loss 3.05. The annualized carry for this pair is approximately 4.7%.

7. Indonesia - BI's larger than expected policy rate hikes and FX measures help to stem IDR depreciation. The IDR has underperformed the Asian FX market this year. To address the currency weakness, Bank Indonesia (BI) hiked rate by 50bps in May and then again by 25bp off-cycle hike in June, whilst announcing some additional measures to encourage FX inflows. BI will raise yields on SRBIs across the 6-, 9-, and 12-month tenors and will reduce the hedging swap rate for foreign investors by 10%, a new tool. The policy action provides some relief for the currency, but does not solve other domestic concerns. First, the government plans to centralize natural resource exports and retain export proceeds in state banks, and business groups are seeking clarity on this policy. While aimed at improving tax revenue and preventing exports under-invoicing, investors are worried that the added bureaucracy can delay exports. Second, Indonesia's parliament passed a law to expand BI's mandate, adding a more explicit pro-growth objective to BI's existing mandate on price and exchange rate stability, leading to investor concerns around the inflation targeting framework. Third, we expect MSCI to provide updated guidance on its treatment of Indonesian equities, including its EM status, by June 23. The above pressures add to the already challenging set of macro-objectives including the President's pro-growth preference, maintaining fuel subsidies, free meal program (1.1% of GDP) and keeping within the 3% fiscal deficit cap. Given these domestic concerns, we remain bearish on the IDR and expect it to underperform NJA FX peers.

Exhibit 6: BI has been raising SRBI yields in an attempt to attract inflows



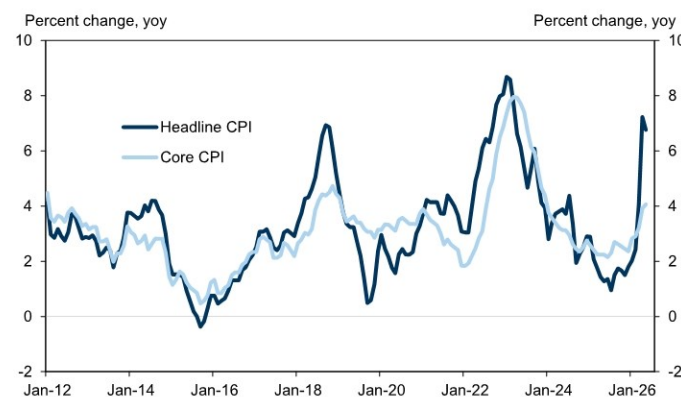
Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

8. Philippines – BSP likely to remain vigilant on inflation and maintain hawkish bias.

The inflation pass-through has been rapid, as fuel prices are largely market determined, with April and May CPI printing at 7.2% yoy and 6.8% yoy, respectively, well above the BSP's target of 3%. During our recent visit to Manila, policymakers shared that based on their 2022 experience, second round effects on inflation tends to peak two quarters after the initial shock. Given their vigilance, the BSP was the first regional central bank to hike rates by 25bps to 4.50% in April, and we expect four more consecutive 25bp hikes to a terminal rate of 5.50%. Economic growth has been weak since H2-2025, partly

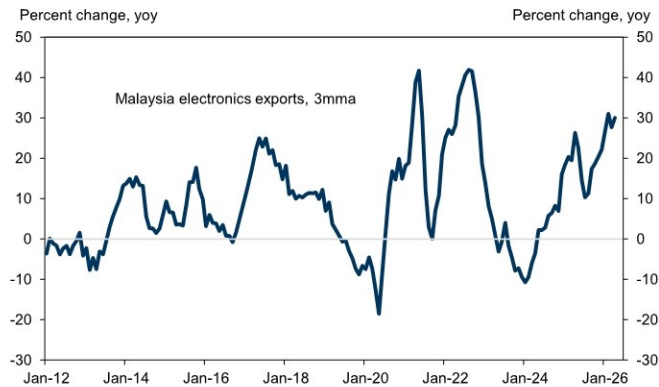
reflecting disruptions from the flood-control corruption scandal, which led to a slowdown in public investment. Real GDP growth printed a soft 2.8% yoy in Q1. Policymakers expect investment to recover in H2-2026, although we (and local investors we met in the Philippines) remain more cautious. Our observation of anti-corruption measures in other economies suggests that the recovery in investments usually takes time. Fiscal consolidation remains a priority, making broad-based fiscal stimulus unlikely. The PHP has underperformed NJA FX this year, as the economy is amongst the most exposed to the energy shock. If oil prices stay elevated (USD 90–100/bbl), then we expect the PHP to stay under pressure. However, if there is resolution in the Middle East and oil prices fall, then we think the PHP local markets could be one of the region's outperformers, as the terms of trade should improve more for the Philippines versus other markets.

Exhibit 7: Inflation pass through in the Philippines has been swift, prompting BSP to be hawkish

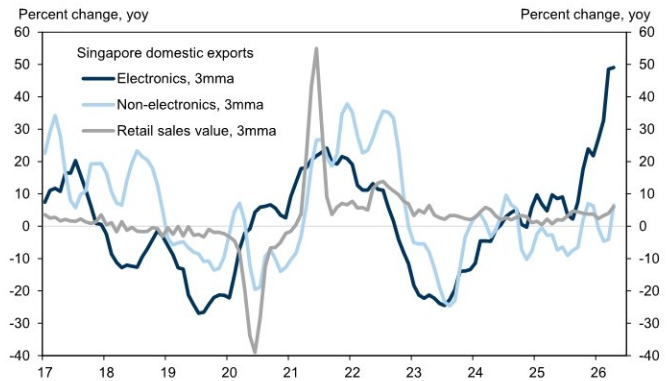


Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

9. Malaysia – Positive MYR, but cautious of rising political risk. The MYR has outperformed NJA for most of this year, given Malaysia's more favourable energy balance and its exposure to the semi-conductor supply chain. Q1 real GDP grew by 5.5% yoy (slightly above expectations), while April exports came in at 37% yoy, well above consensus of 9.5%. Inflation remains well contained, rising just 1.9% yoy in April from 1.7% in March, helped by fuel subsidies. The MYR weakened in June, driven in part by concerns over a potential snap election later this year. Malaysia has seen political stability since the last election in November 2022, with the next election not due until February 2028 and an earlier snap election could bring about uncertainty in the near term. Malaysia has not lifted retail prices on subsidized gasoline at MYR 1.99 per litre since the start of the war. Although this has helped keep a lid on inflation, the subsidy bill rose from around MYR 700mn in January to peak at MYR 7.5bn in April before dipping to MYR 3.5bn in May. The government has reduced the gasoline consumption quota to 200 litres per person, per month from 300 litres. Nevertheless, there has been a brewing concern that the broader fiscal consolidation plan may lose momentum. For now, we do not think the government will raise fuel prices, as they prefer to shield the population from higher energy prices. As such, we expect Bank Negara Malaysia to leave the policy rate unchanged at 2.75%. Unless political instability arises, we think the MYR is still poised to outperform NJA FX. We hold on our short SGD/MYR trade (entry 3.13, target 2.90, stop at 3.30, current at 3.16).

Exhibit 8: Electronics has helped to buffer Malaysian exports....

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 9: ... as well as Singapore's exports

Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

10. Singapore – MAS to stay on hold. Despite being an open economy and facing an energy shock, Singapore's economic momentum has remained firm. Q1 GDP grew 6.0% yoy, which was stronger than consensus of 5.2%, and recent data suggest this strength carried into Q2. In April, industrial production excluding the volatile biomedical segment rose 22% yoy, led by electronics, while non-oil domestic exports increased 25% yoy, also driven by electronics. Even so, stronger growth has yet to translate meaningfully into inflation, as core CPI rose just 1.4% yoy in April (below consensus of 1.8%) and the long-run average of around 2%. We therefore expect the MAS to keep monetary policy settings unchanged at its July meeting, after having just delivered a tightening in April (but with dovish guidance), where they steepened the slope of the SGD NEER appreciation path by 50bps to 1% per annum, according to our estimates. The SGD NEER is trading around +1.5%, on the strong side of the mid-point. Thus, given our expectations for the MAS to keep policy parameters on hold, we do not think there is significant scope for the SGD to outperform NJA FX peers (given it is already near the top-end of the SGD NEER band). As such, we are comfortable using the SGD as a funder for our long MYR position.

11. Thailand – THB should be remain a laggard. Economic growth has held up so far with Q1 GDP growing by 2.8% yoy, up from 2.6% yoy in Q4-2025. Headline CPI rose from deflation territory in Q1 to 2.8% yoy in May, driven by fuel and food. Q2 GDP may see some support from the "Let's Go Halves Plus" program which consists of the co-payment scheme (running from June 1st to September 30th) and welfare card support. The size of the scheme is worth around THB 170bn (0.9% of GDP). Notably, the government announced an emergency decree in May to borrow THB 400bn, half of the proceeds will be used to help vulnerable groups and the other half to facilitate energy transition. The BoT kept rates on hold in April at 1.0% and highlighted that tourism and private consumption are expected to slow due to the impact of the war. They expect inflation to increase temporarily in 2026, before subsiding in 2027, and noted that risk of second-round effects of inflation are limited due to both structural and cyclical factors. They also cited that monetary policy should take into account the sources of inflation and should not respond to supply-side factors that raise inflation this year but are expected to subside next year. Put together, we do not expect the BoT to raise rates this year, which is slightly more dovish than market pricing. Given Thailand's longer term structural issues (such as competition from China in home and destination markets), and the authorities' efforts to de-link the correlation between gold and THB, we think the

THB will likely remain a laggard vs the region, even if oil prices drop.

Summary tables

Exhibit 10: Our views on relative performance of NJA FX and rates (3 month outlook)

	FX outlook*	Rates outlook**	Comments
China	Bullish	Neutral	Export strength, FX undervaluation and PBoC's broader tolerance for CNY strength underpins our bullish CNY view. Recent PBoC actions signal pace management of CNY appreciation.
Korea	Bullish	Neutral	CA surplus buffered, as surge in tech-exports more than offset higher oil. We expect the BoK to hike twice H2-2026 versus the market's pricing of around 5-6 hikes in the next 12-months.
Taiwan	Bullish	Bearish	Robust trade surplus from tech exports and large accumulation of USD deposits presents asymmetric risk for TWD strength. Bearish TWD rates on expectations for CBC hikes.
Hong Kong	Neutral	Neutral	Broad USD strength has pushed USD/HKD towards the upper end of the convertibility band; we expect spot to stay rangebound from here.
India	Neutral	Neutral	FX measures to attract inflows were meaningful. We do not expect significant spot appreciation but like long INR as carry play. We expect the RBI to hike by 50bps in H2-2026.
Singapore	Neutral	Neutral	Growth had held up in Q1, while rise in inflation has been moderate. MAS already pre-emptively tightened policy in April and we do not expect further tightening this year.
Thailand	Bearish	Neutral	Higher oil is negative for growth and current account, while disruption to aviation hubs could further dampen tourism. Policymakers leaning more towards fiscal support.
Malaysia	Bullish	Neutral	MYR should outperform, as Malaysia is a net exporter of energy and part of semi-conductor supply chain. Government likely to sustain subsidies and it prioritizes shielding the population.
Indonesia	Bearish	Bearish	BI rate hikes and FX measures provided short-term relief for IDR. However, concerns on natural resource export rules, governance and fiscal discipline to keep the IDR under pressure.
Philippines	Bearish	Bearish	Philippines is vulnerable to higher energy prices on growth and CA perspective. BSP is vigilant on second-round inflation and remains hawkish (we expect 4 hikes to 4.50%).

*Performance of spot and carry relative to Asian peers; ** Rates market outlook vs. current yield level (reference to 5Y swaps or bond yields)
Italics denote a change from our previous stance.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 11: Trade Ideas in EM Asia rates and FX

Open trades	Initiated	Current	Entry	Target	Stop	Total PnL (capital and carry)
Short THB/INR	12-Jun-26	2.91	2.91	2.70	3.05	+ 0%
Short SGD/MYR	23-Jan-26	3.16	3.13	2.90	3.30	- 0.9%

*Target / Spot-loss levels are expressed in index terms to incorporate the total returns from; i) duration, ii) carry and iii) spot FX where appropriate.

Closed trades	Initiated	Closed	Entry	Closed	Total PnL (capital and carry)
Receive THB THOR 2Y OIS	23-Jan-26	9-Mar-26	1.20%	1.13%	+15bps
Long PHP 5Y bond FX-hedged	5-Aug-25	5-Mar-26	5.93%	5.77%	+32bps
Long INR 30Y bonds FX-hedged	5-Sep-25	11-Feb-26	7.22%	7.47%	+20bps
KRW 2Y IRS	18-Nov-25	4-Feb-26	2.80%	3.16%	-35bps
Short SGD/TWD	3-Oct-25	7-Jan-26	23.57	24.6	-3.80%
Short THB/KRW	10-Jan-25	9-Sep-25	42.3	43.74	-3.30%
Long 1Y SRBIs fully FX hedged	3-Oct-24	21-Jul-25	6.82%	6.58%	+112bp
Long 2Y CGBs	6-Apr-25	16-May-25	1.47%	1.47%	0bp
Receive INR 2Y NDOIS	28-Jan-25	16-May-25	6.08%	5.48%	+44bp
Long KRW 2s10s IRS Steepener	4-Sep-24	16-May-25	-12bp	20bp	+9bp
Long INR vs. Asian FX basket (CNH, TWD, THB, MYR, and SGD with equal weights)	6-Jan-25	3-Apr-25	100	100.33	+33bp
Long 5Y CGB on a FX-hedged basis	17-Nov-24	21-Feb-25	1.69%	1.55%	+14bp
Long INR vs. Asian FX basket (CNY, KRW, TWD, THB, MYR, SGD and JPY with equal weights)	17-Nov-24	6-Jan-24	100	100.48	+114bp
Long 2Y IGBs FX-unhedged	29-Feb-24	6-Nov-24	7.02%	6.50%	+3.8%
Pay THB 2Y THOR OIS	7-Aug-24	1-Oct-24	2.02%	2.04%	+8bp
Short CNY vs. CFETS basket	9-Aug-24	30-Sep-24	100	103	-0.7%
Short EUR/INR	12-Jan-24	21-Aug-24	90.91	93	-0.3%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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